

BoardWalking

From the friendly Village Staff at



Facilitate

like a

Professional!

Two ways we can help you do that:

- 1. Attend a live, 2-Day Facilitator Training Course**
 - We hold an open enrollment facilitator training every quarter and hit every area of the country.
 - Experiential learning at its best - you practice everything you learn!
- 2. Join our Facilitator Membership and learn all the tips and tricks from our professional facilitators.**
 - Video, audio, PDFs and more - you learn at your own pace.
 - Cancel at any time and use as much as you like.

Visit our website, www.TeamBuildingActivity.com for more information. You can also call us at 800-513-8759 and speak with any of our facilitators for help.

BoardWalking

Objective

BoardWalking is an activity to show the importance of unity and synchronization. BoardWalking is one of the few activities that necessitates the exact timing of the groups effort for success.

The Challenge? For the group to create a method for successfully moving the team through a planned space in the most efficient way possible. This can be a short distance to retrieve an object, or simply to coordinate the synchronized movement of the group through a winding path.

Materials

The materials you need are included in your kit:

- 8 boards with rope
- 6 Quicklinks
- Start / Stop line
- Eyeshades
- Guidebook



Setup of Activity

There is one basic way to set up BoardWalking with MANY variations to keep it fun for you and the participants. Below is the basic setup. See Setup Variations for additional ways to execute the activity.

THE RACE!

1. Break the group into four teams, two to three people per team.
2. Each team is given two boards to walk on, one for their left foot and one for their right foot.
3. Set them up behind the 'Start' line and the teams race to the 'Finish' line.
4. Sit back and prepare to laugh! And take LOTS of notes about the dynamics for your debrief.



Activity Variations

There are several variations that will create greater challenges and change the dynamics of the entire group in meaningful ways.

Pickup

Place various team members at certain spots and the boardwalkers must pick up their teammates before crossing the finish line.

Dropoff

The opposite of Pickup, in Dropoff, you drop off players at certain locations before you cross the finish line.

Backwards

Simple - instead of walking forward, make them walk backward.

REMEMBER! You are the Grand Master of the activity - make changes any time you want. If one team is far better than others, blindfold them, pick up an obstacle in front of one team and put it in front of the better group. They will complain and say you were 'cheating', but obstacles are placed in our path unfairly at any given time in life.



Universal Variations:

- Blindfolds - you can blindfold one or more members of the team
- Obstacles
- Move the Finish line - put it further away, closer or move it to right in front of another team
- Silence - silence one or more members on a team, or possibly the entire group. Participants often try to call out "left-right" or "one-two" to indicate which one of the boardwalkers they wish to move. As a facilitator, you can limit their choices, or perhaps more appropriately, encourage their creativity by asking them to use phrases other than "one-two" or "left-right."
- Time - make the race, not against each other, but against personal records
- Overall time - you add ALL the teams times together for an overall cumulative time. Let them race for time first, then give them their 'time', which will not make sense. Watch how quickly the dynamics change and teams help one another get faster.



Setup Variations

GroupWalking

Connect, using the Quicklinks, two or more of the boards together. If you connect two together, you now have two teams racing instead of four.

You can also connect ALL of the boards together and the entire group will have to walk together. This is VERY challenging and has great leadership, communication and visioning applications.

Discussion Questions

1. How did your group decide on the technique they were going to use?
2. Was this technique useful for keeping the group in step with each other? Did your group experience breakdown? What happened then?
3. Which was easier, going straight, turning, or backing up? Did your group find it harder to turn to the left or the right?
4. Did your group begin and end with the same technique? Are there any other techniques?
5. What are situations in which groups must work in synchronization? How does unity and synchronization, or lack thereof, change the group's performance?
6. What lessons can you take away from this activity?



Dynamics to Watch for in the Group and Individuals

Frustration can occur easily, especially in a competitive group.

Laughter can occur just as easily. Be sure to celebrate laughter and acknowledge it during the debrief.

Cooperation and Collaboration is not a natural habit for most groups. Watch for any sign of this occurring and reinforce it both during the activity and refer back to it during your debrief.

Tips and Tricks from Professional Facilitators

Breakdown

Boardwalking is an excellent activity for discussing the occurrence of “breakdown.” Breakdown is the process by which a working technique suddenly falls apart. Establishing a method for successfully keeping in step is one thing. Keeping this technique going is quite another. Typically breakdown occurs because the technique or method does not allow for any small variations from the plan. A slight overstep or an error in timing can make the difference between moving the group forward, and going nowhere.

Path

The path that the group takes can add many elements of challenge to this activity. Generally going around some objects is better than going over them, although slight inclines can be interesting. Having the group turn a corner, or even backing up, provides some additional challenges.

Support

Call Us at 800-513-8759!

We are absolutely happy to help you with any questions you might have with your materials or activities.

www.TeambuildingActivity.com

Visit our website for additional support, videos , variations and more our launch will be on January 1, 2013!

As part of your purchase, you will have access to the information for the activities included in this guide. You will also have access to facilitator information which will help you execute these activities better.

